

Hindu Gods' Timeline

What the Puranas say - and what the texts, science and archaeology actually back up

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Short answer. The time framework (Yugas, Mahayugas, Manvantaras, Kalpas, divine years, the 28 Vyasas, "we are in the 28th Kali Yuga") is faithful to the Puranas - you can check every number against the texts. A widely circulated reconstruction of the gods' timeline goes further and (1) turns Purana stories into exact dates of millions of years ago, and (2) matches them to real science (the dinosaur asteroid, the Himalayas, zircons, NASA's twin astronauts). The science facts it quotes are mostly real, but the links are its own, a few details are off, and nothing in archaeology or fossils shows humans or kingdoms millions of years ago. The geography, though, is partly real: Lanka, Ayodhya, Hastinapur, Kurukshetra, Dwarka and the Saraswati all have identifiable places on today's map, and some of what has been dug up there genuinely matches the texts - at dates of a few thousand years ago, not millions.

How this report was made. Every claim was checked against the live sources on 24 September 2026. The screenshots at the back show the exact line on the live page, highlighted in yellow with a red box. Sources are numbered and listed with links at the end. This edition is written to be published as open source: the Licenses section lists the terms for every screenshot and quote.

How to read the labels:

MATCHES THE TEXTS

SCRIPTURE SAYS IT - FAITH CLAIM, NO PHYSICAL PROOF

THE RECONSTRUCTION'S OWN INTERPRETATION

PARTLY RIGHT

CONFLICTS WITH EVIDENCE

NOT VERIFIED

1. The time system (this part checks out)

Unit	Length in human years
1 day of the gods	1 human year
1 divine year	360 human years
Krita / Satya Yuga	1,728,000
Treta Yuga	1,296,000
Dvapara Yuga	864,000
Kali Yuga	432,000
1 Mahayuga (Chaturyuga) = 12,000 divine years	4,320,000
1 Manvantara = 71 Mahayugas	306,720,000
1 Kalpa = 1 day of Brahma = 1,000 Mahayugas (14 Manvantaras + gaps)	4,320,000,000
Brahma's life = 100 Brahma-years	~311 trillion

MATCHES THE TEXTS Source: Wikipedia "Yuga cycle" and "Hindu units of time" [1][2], which cite the Manusmriti, Surya Siddhanta and Puranas. Scholars note this scheme appears in texts from roughly the last centuries BCE onward (Mahabharata, Manusmriti, Puranas) - it is a religious cosmology, not a measured timeline.

2. The Puranic timeline of the gods

A widely shared reconstruction (drawn from the Kurma, Vayu, Matsya, Devi Bhagavata and Padma Puranas) places the famous stories Mahayuga by Mahayuga. "Years ago" are the reconstruction's own figures, counted back from about 2023. The arithmetic is consistent: each Mahayuga start = 27 full Mahayugas + the 3,893,124 years already elapsed in this one - it adds up. The order of avatars and the Vyasa names really do come from the Puranas. The exact "millions of years ago" dates are the reconstruction's calculation from those texts - **no inscription, fossil or artifact supports any of these events at those dates.**

Mahayuga	Years ago (approx.)	Events placed here
1	120.5M	Brahma himself is Vyasa. Shiva roams as 'Sutara'.
2	116.2M	Vaivasvata Manu rules; very few humans. Vyasa: Satya.
4	107.6M	Hiranyakashipu & Prahlada; Vishnu's Narasimha avatar (Krita Yuga).
5	103.3M	Prahlada is king of the Asuras; his son Virochana born.
6	98.9M	Bali born; Asuras roam Earth. Reconstruction: 'Cretaceous, dinosaurs'.
7	94.6M	Vamana avatar sends Bali to Sutala (Treta Yuga).
8	90.3M	Tarakasura born. Vyasa: Vasishtha.
10	81.7M	Dattatreya born to Atri & Anasuya (reconstruction cites Brahmanda Purana 2.3).
13	68.7-64.4M	Reconstruction links the dinosaur-killing asteroid (Chicxulub) to this Mahayuga.
15	60.1M	Mandhata rules Ayodhya; reconstruction says the Himalayas start forming.
17	51.4M	Reconstruction reads the Vayu Purana as saying the highest Himalayan peak appears.
19	42.8M	Parashurama born to Jamadagni & Renuka. Vyasa: Bharadwaja.

21	34.1M	Ravana does penance, gets Brahma's boons; Mali/Sumali defeated.
23	25.5M	Muchukunda goes to fight for the gods; Ravana kills King Anaranya; Bhagiratha brings the Ganga; Kumara Swamy kills Tarakasura.
24	21.2M	Rama avatar - the Ramayana (Treta Yuga). Vyasa: Riksha (Valmiki).
25	16.9M	Rama's descendants (Kusha, Atithi...) rule. Vyasa: Vasishtha / Shakti.
26	12.5M	Vyasa: Parashara.
27	8.2M	Vyasa: Jatukarnya.
28	now	Krishna, the Mahabharata, Vyasa = Krishna Dvaipayana. Kali Yuga began 3102 BCE. Kalki expected at the end of this Kali Yuga (~426,873 years left).

3. Claim-by-claim check

The claims below all come from the reconstruction examined in this report. Each was checked against the texts and against live sources on 24 September 2026.

Claim	What the sources say	Ref
Time units: 1 human year = 1 day of the gods; 1 divine year = 360 human years; a Mahayuga = 4,320,000 years; 71 Mahayugas = 1 Manvantara; 14 Manvantaras = 1 Kalpa (a day of Brahma).	MATCHES THE TEXTS Exactly what the Puranic/Manusmriti system says (Wikipedia: Yuga cycle; Hindu units of time).	[1] [2]
We are in Brahma's 51st year, Shveta Varaha Kalpa, 7th (Vaivasvata) Manvantara, 28th Mahayuga, first quarter of Kali Yuga.	MATCHES THE TEXTS Matches the traditional sankalpa reckoning (Wikipedia: Manvantara).	[3]
Kali Yuga began about 5,125 years ago, on 17/18 February (3102 BCE), when Krishna left the Earth.	SCRIPTURE SAYS IT - FAITH CLAIM, NO PHYSICAL PROOF This is the traditional date (Aryabhata, 5th-6th century CE). As of 2026 it is about 5,127 years ago. It is a calendar tradition, not something proven by astronomy or archaeology. The Aihole inscription (634 CE) independently counts 3,735 years from the Bharata war, which works out to the same 3102 BCE.	[4]
A different Vyasa arranged the Vedas in each of the 28 Dvapara Yugas; the 24th was Riksha (Valmiki), the 26th Parashara, the 28th Krishna Dvaipayana.	MATCHES THE TEXTS Confirmed by Vishnu Purana 3.3. Some names differ between Puranas (e.g. the 20th is Gotama in the Vishnu Purana, 'Mahamati' in Vayu-based lists).	[5]
The Ramayana happened in the 24th Mahayuga's Treta Yuga, about 18-21 million years ago - 'not 7,000 years ago'.	SCRIPTURE SAYS IT - FAITH CLAIM, NO PHYSICAL PROOF There IS a Purana verse for this: Vayu Purana 70.47-48 (quoted by secondary sources) places Rama in the 24th Treta Yuga. But modern humans (Homo sapiens) only appear about 300,000 years ago, and scholars date the Ramayana text to roughly the 8th-4th century BCE.	[6] [14] [15]
The Mahabharata war happened about 5,100 years ago, at the end of this Mahayuga's Dvapara Yuga.	SCRIPTURE SAYS IT - FAITH CLAIM, NO PHYSICAL PROOF Traditional view (3102 BCE). Historians mostly place a possible Kuru-era core around the 10th century BCE; the text itself was compiled about the 3rd century BCE to 4th century CE. The historicity of the war is unclear.	[13]
Muchukunda fought in heaven for 58,800 'divine' years while about 2.1 crore human years passed on Earth (time dilation).	THE RECONSTRUCTION'S OWN INTERPRETATION The arithmetic is right ($4 \times 4.32M + 3.888M = 21.168M$; $/ 360 = 58,800$). But the source text (Bhagavata 10.51.14-21) gives no number and says that after Kartikeya took over, Muchukunda went to a CAVE and SLEPT until Krishna's time - so the text does not say all that time passed in heaven. The Bhagavata also calls him Mandhata's son, while the reconstruction places Mandhata 8 Mahayugas earlier (15th vs 23rd/24th).	[7]
King Khatvanga reached Earth from heaven in 24 minutes; 24 min at light speed = 43.2 crore km - 'the same 432 as a Mahayuga'.	CONFLICTS WITH EVIDENCE Bhagavata 9.9.42 only says the gods told him he had 'one moment (muhurta) of life' left; it gives no 24-minute flight. The 432 'match' comes from rounding light speed to 300,000 km/s ($24 \times 60 \times 300,000 = 432,000,000$). With the real value (299,792.458 km/s) it is about 431.7 million km - a coincidence of round numbers.	[8]
Time runs differently in other lokas (the Kakudmi/Revati pattern).	MATCHES THE TEXTS The Puranas really do contain this idea: in Bhagavata 9.3.32, Brahma tells Kakudmi 'twenty-seven catur-yugas have already passed' during his short visit. This is the strongest textual support for the idea.	[9]
NASA's twin astronaut test proved the space twin came back younger.	PARTLY RIGHT Time dilation is real physics, but Scott Kelly's difference after a year on the ISS was only about 5 milliseconds. It does not support million-year gaps.	[10]
The dinosaur-killing asteroid hit at the end of the 13th Mahayuga's Kali Yuga; the crater was found in 1970; the asteroid was 11-81 km.	THE RECONSTRUCTION'S OWN INTERPRETATION Science: the impact was about 66 million years ago, the asteroid about 10 km, the crater about 180 km, spotted by Penfield and Camargo in the late 1970s (1978). By the reconstruction's own dating, 66 million years ago falls in the Treta Yuga of the 13th Mahayuga, not the end of its Kali Yuga. No Purana mentions an asteroid - the link is the reconstruction's.	[11]
The Himalayas began forming in the 15th Mahayuga (about 60 million years ago); the Vayu Purana names new peaks rising Mahayuga by Mahayuga.	THE RECONSTRUCTION'S OWN INTERPRETATION Geology: the India-Asia collision and Himalayan uplift began about 40-50 million years ago (USGS). The rough era is in the same ballpark, but the Vayu Purana reading is the reconstruction's; the Sanskrit verses were not independently checked.	[12]
Dinosaurs, Asuras, Rakshasas and some humans lived together (6th-14th Mahayuga); the Solar and Lunar dynasties survived the asteroid.	CONFLICTS WITH EVIDENCE No fossil evidence of any humans that early. Homo sapiens (modern humans) appears only about 300,000 years ago - over 60 million years after the dinosaurs died out.	[14]
An ice age was going on about 15,000	PARTLY RIGHT	[16]

years before the Mahabharata war.	Roughly consistent: the Last Glacial Maximum was 26,000-20,000 years ago, and the ice melted after that (3102 BCE minus 15,000 years is about 20,000 years ago).	
Jack Hills zircons are 4.26 billion years old (427 crore) - hinting at a Kalpa of 4.32 billion years.	PARTLY RIGHT The oldest Jack Hills zircon is about 4.4 billion years (4.374 Ga); the Earth is about 4.54 billion. And by the traditional reckoning only about 1.97 billion years of the current Kalpa have passed - so the Earth is older than the current Kalpa's elapsed time. The resemblance is loose.	[17] [18] [2]
Dasharatha lived 60,000 years; people of each Yuga had fixed lifespans.	SCRIPTURE SAYS IT - FAITH CLAIM, NO PHYSICAL PROOF Valmiki Ramayana 1.20.10 does have Dasharatha say 'sixty thousand years since my birth'. That is what the text says, not a biological fact. The per-Yuga lifespan scheme was not verified in a primary text.	[19]
Kumara Swamy (Kartikeya) started fighting Tarakasura about 5,500 years ago, then married Valli at Srisailam.	NOT VERIFIED No text we checked gives that date. The Puranas place the Deva-Tarakasura war in a far earlier era, and the Srisailam-Valli detail could not be verified.	-

4. The places of the epics on today's map

New in this edition. The epics name real geography. Here is where each famous place sits on the modern map, and what has actually been found there. Every fact below is from the sources in brackets, checked live on 24 September 2026.

4.1 Lanka and the Rama Setu (Adam's Bridge)

What the epic says. Ravana's Lanka is an island fortress on the Trikuta mountains; the Ramayana says it lay 100 yojanas from the mainland, and that Rama's vanara army built a bridge (Setu) to reach it. [21]

The traditional identification. Lanka = present-day Sri Lanka; the bridge = Adam's Bridge (Rama Setu), a 48 km chain of limestone shoals between Pamban Island (Rameswaram, Tamil Nadu) and Mannar Island (Sri Lanka). The 5th-century Sri Lankan chronicle Mahavamsa calls the island Lanka, and medieval Chola copper plates use the same equation. But some medieval commentators and some modern scholars separate the two: proposed alternatives include Madhya Pradesh, the Maldives, Sumatra and Madagascar, and the Ramayana itself never gives a modern-mappable location. [20] [21]

What science says about the bridge. It is a natural formation - a tombolo of shoals, sandbars and patch reefs. During the Last Glacial Period (115,000-11,700 years ago), sea levels were up to 120 m lower and the whole shallow Palk Strait was dry land connecting India and Sri Lanka. The strait went under by about 7,000 years ago, and the shoals emerged again as sea levels fell in the region from about 5,000 years ago. Claims that the structure is man-made (made in 2007 by a former Geological Survey of India director) were rejected: NASA said its satellite photos show a natural feature and had been misinterpreted, and the Archaeological Survey of India told the Supreme Court it found no evidence the structure was anything but natural, and no historical proof of a bridge built by Rama. [20]

SCRIPTURE SAYS IT The island and the bridge are in the epic; the bridge itself is real but natural. **PARTLY RIGHT** Lanka = Sri Lanka is the mainstream traditional view, debated by scholars.

4.2 Ayodhya

Ayodhya, on the Sarayu river in Uttar Pradesh, is identified with Rama's capital of Kosala. The historical city was long known as Saketa: Buddhist and Jain texts describe Saketa as a major city of Kosala, and archaeology says the site had become an urban settlement by the 5th-6th century BCE. A large brick fortification wall found there is dated to about the 3rd century BCE. From the Gupta period (4th century CE) onward, texts use Ayodhya and Saketa for the same city; one scholarly theory holds that the Gupta emperor Skandagupta renamed Saketa after the legendary city. [22]

PARTLY RIGHT Ayodhya/Saketa is real and about 2,500 years old as a city. That fits a late-BCE epic setting, not a date millions of years ago.

4.3 Hastinapur and Kurukshetra

The Mahabharata's capital is a real town in Uttar Pradesh, about 37 km from Meerut; Kurukshetra, the traditional battlefield, is a real district in Haryana. B.B. Lal's 1950-52 ASI excavations at Hastinapur found the city of the Painted Grey Ware culture, dated roughly 1100-800 BCE. Lal also found a major flood layer around 800 BCE - and the Mahabharata itself says that in king Nichakshu's reign "a great flood occurred in the Ganga which carried away a considerable portion of Hastinapura", after which the capital moved to Kaushambi. Lal suggested this tradition "may have a historical basis". A 2021 excavation report pushes the site's occupation back to about 1500-1000 BCE. [23] Historians place a possible Kuru-era core of the epic around the 10th century BCE. [13]

PARTLY RIGHT This is the strongest text-to-archaeology match of any epic site, but the dates are around 3,000 years ago - consistent with a ~10th century BCE Kuru core, not with 3102 BCE, and not with millions of years.

4.4 Dwarka

Krishna's city, which the Mahabharata says was swallowed by the sea, is a real coastal town in Gujarat. ASI investigations (on land from 1963, offshore later) found submerged settlements on the seaward side: exterior and interior walls, fort bastions, a large stone-built jetty and triangular three-holed stone anchors - the remains of an ancient port, probably destroyed by coastal erosion. One excavated settlement is described as "probably contemporary to Mahabharata, dated around 2nd millennium BCE", and nearby Bet Dwarka is a Late Harappan site with a thermoluminescence date of 1570 BCE. The oldest temple structure at the Dwarkadhish temple is dated to about 200 BCE. [24]

PARTLY RIGHT There really are submerged ruins off Dwarka, which fits the story of a city lost to the sea. The dated material is from the 2nd millennium BCE onward: old, but far younger than a 3102 BCE Krishna - and nowhere near millions of years.

4.5 The Sinauli carts

In 2018, ASI excavations at Sinauli in the Ganga-Yamuna doab (Uttar Pradesh) uncovered royal coffin burials with full-sized wooden carts with solid, copper-sheeted wheels, plus copper swords and helmets. Carbon dating places the burials at about 1865-1507 BCE. The excavation director presented the vehicles as war chariots and linked the burial rituals to Vedic practice; other scholars note that solid wheels belong to carts, not the spoked-wheel chariots of the epics. [25]

PARTLY RIGHT Spectacular Bronze Age finds in the right region, but they predate even the traditional 3102 BCE war by over a thousand years, and the "chariot" reading is debated.

4.6 The Saraswati river

The Rigveda's "great and holy river" is described in later Vedic texts and the Mahabharata as drying up in a desert. Since the 19th century, many scholars have identified it with the seasonal Ghaggar-Hakra river between the Yamuna and the Sutlej, and ISRO has noted that major Harappan sites (Kalibangan, Banawali, Rakhigarhi, Dholavira, Lothal) lie along that course. Recent geophysical work

complicates the picture: the deep paleochannel under the Ghaggar-Hakra was actually a course of the Sutlej, abandoned 10,000-8,000 years ago, and the Hakra itself dried up about 4,000 years ago - before the Rigveda is conventionally dated. The identification is still debated. [26]

PARTLY RIGHT A real river system that really dried up, matching the texts' memory; whether it is the Rigvedic Saraswati is unresolved.

4.7 Mount Kailash

Shiva's home is a real 6,638 m mountain in the Gangdise range of the Transhimalaya, in western Tibet, near the sources of the Indus, Sutlej, Brahmaputra and Ghaghara. It is sacred to Hindus, Buddhists, Jains and Bon followers, and climbing it is prohibited. Mount Meru, by contrast, is cosmological - the center of the universe in Puranic geography - and is not identified with any real peak. [27]

SCRIPTURE SAYS IT The sacred geography points at a real mountain; the cosmic geography around it is faith, not geology.

5. Bottom line

Solid: the Yuga/Manvantara/Kalpa math, the idea that we are in the 28th Mahayuga's Kali Yuga, the Vyasa list, and the fact that the Puranas themselves describe time passing differently in other worlds (Kakudmi, Muchukunda).

Real text, not physical proof: the Ramayana in the 24th Treta Yuga, Dasharatha's 60,000 years, Kali Yuga starting 3102 BCE. These are what the scriptures say. History and archaeology date the epics very differently.

The reconstruction's own theory: the 58,800-year war calculation, and tying the asteroid and the Himalayas to specific Mahayugas. Interesting, but not in the texts and not testable as stated.

Off: the 24-minute / 432 "match", the crater-discovery year, and humans living alongside dinosaurs.

New in this edition - the places are real, at real dates: Ayodhya (urban by about 500 BCE), Hastinapur (city about 1100-800 BCE, with a flood that matches the text), Dwarka (a submerged port, 2nd millennium BCE onward), Sinauli (Bronze Age carts, about 1865-1507 BCE), the Ghaggar-Hakra (dried about 4,000 years ago) and Adam's Bridge (a natural 48 km tombolo, dry land during the last ice age). The epic map is not fantasy - but everything that can be dug up and dated lands in the last few thousand years, not millions.

6. Screenshots of the proof

Live pages captured on 24 September 2026. The relevant line is highlighted in yellow with a red box. Six proofs ([6]-[10] and [14]) are given as short attributed quotations instead of screenshots, so that every image in this document is freely licensed - see section 8.

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From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

This article is about Hindu ages; not to be confused with Buddhist ages, Greek ages, or Jain ages.

A **yuga cycle** (𑂔𑂗𑂢𑂰, *chatur yuga*, *maha yuga*, etc.) is a cyclic age (epoch) in Hindu cosmology. Each cycle lasts for 4,320,000 years (12,000 divine years^[1]) and repeats four *yugas* (world ages): *Krita* (*Satya*) *Yuga*, *Treta Yuga*, *Dvapara Yuga*, and *Kali Yuga*.^[4]

As a *yuga* cycle progresses through the four *yugas*, each *yuga*'s length and humanity's general moral and physical state within each *yuga* decrease by one-fourth. *Kali Yuga*, which lasts for 432,000 years, is believed to have started in 3102 BCE.^{[5][6]} Near the end of *Kali Yuga*, when virtues are at their worst, a cataclysm and a reestablishment of *dharma* occur to usher in the next cycle's *Krita* (*Satya*) *Yuga*, prophesied to occur by *Kalki*.^[7]

There are 71 *yuga* cycles in a *manvantara* (age of *Manu*) and 1,000 *yuga* cycles in a *kalpa* (day of *Brahma*).^[6]

Lexicology

[edit]

A *yuga* cycle has several names.

Age or *Yuga* (Sanskrit: युग, *lit.* 'an age of the gods'):^[citation needed]

"Age" and "Yuga", sometimes with reverential capitalization, commonly denote a "*catur-yuga*", a cycle of four world ages, unless expressly limited by the name of one of its minor ages (e.g. *Kali Yuga*).^{[8][9]} Its archaic spelling is *yug*, with other forms of *yugam*, *yugānām*, and *yuge*, derived from *yuj* (Sanskrit: युज्, *lit.* 'to join or yoke'), believed derived from **yeug-* (Proto-Indo-European: *lit.* 'to join or unite').^[11]

Chatur Yuga (Sanskrit: चतुर्युग, *romanized:* *caturyuga*, *catur-yuga*, *chaturyuga*, or *chatur-yuga*, *lit.* '*catur* means four';^[citation needed] a set of the four ages):^[12]

A cyclic age encompassing the four *yuga* ages^{[6][13]} as defined in Hindu texts: *Surya Siddhanta*,^[8] *Manusmriti*,^[14] and *Bhagavata Purana*.^[15]

Daiva Yuga (Sanskrit: दैवयुग, *romanized:* *daivayuga* or *daiva-yuga*, *lit.* 'a divine or celestial age; an age of the gods').^[16]

Appearance

hide

Text

☐ Small

☒ Standard

☐ Large

☒ Standard

☐ Wide

☐ Automatic

☒ Light

☐ Dark

[1] Yuga cycle = 4,320,000 years = 12,000 divine years (Wikipedia)

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Kali Yuga

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For other uses, see *Kalyug (disambiguation)*.

*This article is about the age associated with **Kali (demon)**. It is not to be confused with **goddess Kālī**.*

Kali Yuga (**Devanagari**: कलियुग), in **Hinduism**, is the fourth, shortest and worst of the four *yugas* (world ages) in a *Yuga cycle*, preceded by *Dvapara Yuga* and followed by the next cycle's *Krita (Satya) Yuga*. It is believed to be the present age, which is full of conflict and sin.^[1]^[2]^[3]

According to [Puranic sources](#),^[a] [Krishna's death](#) marked the end of [Dvapara Yuga](#) and the start of [Kali Yuga](#), at midnight 17/18 February 3102 [BCE \(Julian\)](#), or 22/23 January ([Gregorian](#)).^{[9][10]} Lasting 432,000 years (1,200 divine years), [Kali Yuga](#) began 5,127 years ago and has 426,873 years left as of 2026 CE,^{[11][12][13]} ending in 428,899 CE.^{[14][b]}

Near the end of *Kali Yuga*, when vices are at their worst, a cataclysm will reestablish *dharma* to usher in the next cycle's *Krita* (*Satya*) *Yuga*, as prophesied by *Kalki*.^[15]

Etymology [\[edit \]](#)

Yuga (Sanskrit: युग), in this context, means "an age of the world", where its archaic spelling is *yug*, with other forms of *yugam*, *yugānām*, and *yuge*, derived from *yuj* (Sanskrit: युज्, *iit.* 'to join or yoke'), believed derived from **yeug-* (Proto-Indo-European: *iit.* 'to join or unite').^[16]

Kali Yuga (**Sanskrit**: कलियुग, **romanized**: *kaliyuga* or *kali-yuga*) means "the age of **Kali**", "the age of darkness", "the age of vice and misery", or "the age of quarrel and hypocrisy".^[17]

A complete description of Kali Yuga is found in the [Mahabharata](#), [Manusmriti](#), [Vishnu Smriti](#), and various [Puranas](#).^[18]

[4] Kali Yuga start: midnight 17/18 February 3102 BCE (Wikipedia)

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Location and history

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Date _____

Inscription

Significance

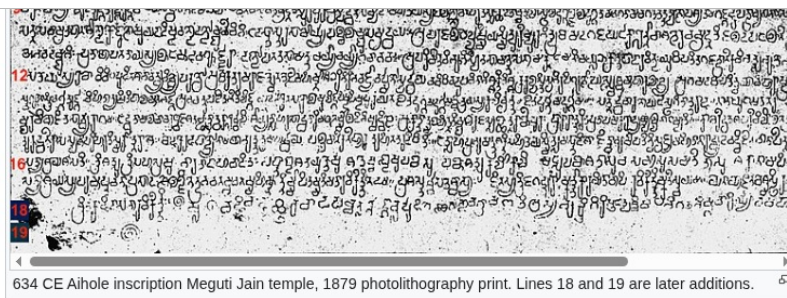
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Date [[edit](#)]

The verses 33–34 of the inscription state the date, 3735 after the Bharata war,^[note 1] or *saka samvat* 556. This corresponds to 634–635 CE.^{[16][3]}

Inscription [\[edit \]](#)

The nineteen lines of the inscription have been variously translated, some of the music of the original lost in the European translation. The translation published by Kielhorn is as follows:^[17]

Aihole inscription		
Verses	Translation (Franz Kielhorn) ^[17]	Notes
	Victorious is the holy Jinendra — he who is exempt from old age, death and birth — in the sea of whose knowledge the whole world is comprised like an island	

[4] Aihole inscription: the date is stated as 3735 years after the Bharata war, corresponding to 634-635 CE - which works out to 3102 BCE (Wikipedia)

Appearance

hide

Text

☐ Small

 Standard

☐ Large

Widt

 Standard

☐ Wide

Colo

☐ Automatic

☐ Light

☐ Dark

Various traditions All glossaries Subhashita	Seeing humankind lacks courage, strength and energy, he divides the Veda for the good of every being. 6 The form that Viṣṇu takes, that enemy of Madhu, when he divides the Veda, is known as 'Veda-vyāsa'. 7 Now you'll learn about the varied Vyāsas who appear in this Manvantara, sage, and how the division into branches is undertaken. 8 The Vedas have been divided on twenty-eight occasions by great sages during each successive Dvāpara age in this Vaivasvata Manvantara. 9 Twenty-eight Veda-vyāsas, who arranged the Vedas into four in each Dvāpara age, best of sages, have already gone by. 10 In the first Dvāpara, the Vedas were arranged by the self-existent deity Brahmā. In the second, the Veda-vyāsa was the patriarch Manu. 11 In the third, the arranger was Uśanas, and in the fourth Br̥haspati. Savitṛ was the arranger in the fifth, and in the sixth was Mṛtyu, Lord of Death. 12 In the seventh it was Indra, and Vasiṣṭha in the eighth, Sārasvata in the ninth and Tridhāman in the tenth. 13 In the eleventh it was Trivṛṣan, and Bhāradvāja followed him. In the thirteenth it was Antarikṣa, and Varṇin in the fourteenth, 14 Trayyāruṇa in the fifteenth, in the sixteenth Dhananjaya, Kṛtanjaya in the seventeenth and Ṛnjaya in the eighteenth. 15 The next Vyāsa was Bharadvāja, and after him came Gautama. After Gautama the Vyāsa was Uttama, also known as Haryātman. 16 After Haryātman was Vena or Vājaśravas, then Soma Śuśmāyaṇa or Tṛṇabindu. 17 Then came Ṛkṣa, scion of Bhṛgu, also known as Vālmīki. After him was my father, Śakti, sage, and I was the Vyāsa after him. 18 Jātukarṇa followed me, then Kṛṣṇa Dvaipāyana. These are the twenty-eight Veda-vyāsas of ancient times. 19 They split the single Veda into four in each Dvāpara age. 20 In the next Dvāpara period, Droṇa's son Drauṇi will be the Vyāsa after my son, the sage Kṛṣṇa Dvaipāyana, has passed. 21 The syllable Om̐ and the Absolute Om̐ is defined as the Absolute (brahman) in the form of one eternal syllable. It's so called on account of its greatness (br̥hatvāt) and its capacity to strengthen (br̥mhaṇatvāt). 22 I bow to the Absolute in the form of the everlasting syllable, Om̐, invoked as 'earth, sky and heaven' (bhūr, bhuvas, svaḥ) in the Rg, Yajur, Sāma and Atharva Vedas. 23 I bow to the Absolute, known as the cause of creation and destruction of the world, the deepest secret of mahat, the principle of Greatness. 24 Unfathomable, unbound and undecaying, it's the source of illusion in the world. With brilliance and efficacy, it's the cause by which the purpose of the highest spirit is accomplished. 25 The Absolute is the crown for those who know the Sāṃkhya teachings, and the goal for those who pacify and regulate themselves. It's unmanifest, undying efficacy. 26 It's also called the essence, the origin of the Self, the heart of all reality. It's indivisible, pure, imperishable and manifold. 27
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[5] Vishnu Purana 3.3: the 28 Vyasas - 24th Riksha = Valmiki, then Shakti, Parashara, Krishna Dvaipayana (wisdomlib)

"In the twenty-fourth Tretayuga, owing to the cessation of merits of his penance, he (Ravana) met Rama, the son of Dasaratha, an attained to doom along with his clan."

Vayu Purana, chapter 70, verse 48, translation as quoted at <https://rajasrinivasan.wordpress.com/2020/06/14/when-did-ramayana-happen/> (c) the author; short excerpt quoted with attribution for review. The verse itself is an ancient text.

[6] Vayu Purana 70.48 quoted: Rama in the 24th Treta Yuga (quoted translation; the verse is an ancient text)

"Addressed thus, King Muchukunda took his respectful leave of the demigods and went to a cave, where he lay down to enjoy the sleep they had granted him."

Srimad Bhagavatam 10.51.21, <https://vedabase.io/en/library/sb/10/51/> - Translation (c) The Bhaktivedanta Book Trust International. Short excerpt quoted with attribution for review and criticism.

[7] Bhagavata 10.51.21: Muchukunda "went to a cave, where he lay down" (quoted text)

"The King inquired from them about the duration of his life and was informed that he had only one moment more. Thus he immediately left his palace and went to his own residence, where he engaged his mind fully on the lotus feet of the Lord."

Srimad Bhagavatam 9.9.42, <https://vedabase.io/en/library/sb/9/9/42/> - Translation (c) The Bhaktivedanta Book Trust International. Short excerpt quoted with attribution for review and criticism.

[8] Bhagavata 9.9.42: Khatvanga told he had "only one moment more" (quoted text)

Srimad Bhagavatam 9.3.32, <https://vedabase.io/en/library/sb/9/3/32/> - Translation (c) The Bhaktivedanta Book Trust International. Short excerpt quoted with attribution for review and criticism.

"Because the ISS is not traveling anywhere near the speed of light relative to us, time dilation – or the slowing of time due to motion – is very minimal. So any age difference between the brothers would only be a few milliseconds."

[10] Kelly twins: the age difference 'would only be a few milliseconds' (quoted text)

[11] Chicxulub: formed about 66 million years ago by a roughly 10 km asteroid (Wikipedia)

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The Alvarezes, joined by [Frank Asaro](#) and [Helen Michel](#) from [University of California, Berkeley](#), published their paper on the iridium anomaly in [Science](#) in June 1980.^[11] Almost simultaneously [Jan Smit](#) and [Jan Hertogen](#) published their iridium findings from Caravaca, Spain, in [Nature](#) in May 1980.^[14] These papers were followed by other reports of similar iridium spikes at the K–Pg boundary across the globe, and sparked wide interest in the cause of the K–Pg extinction; over 2,000 papers were published in the 1980s on the topic.^{[13]:82[15]} There were no known impact craters that were the right age and size, spurring a search for a suitable candidate.^[9] Recognizing the scope of the work, Lee Hunt and Lee Silver organized a cross-discipline meeting in [Snowbird, Utah](#), in 1981. Unknown to them, evidence of the crater they were looking for was being presented the same week, and would be largely missed by the scientific community.^{[13]:83–84[15]}

In 1978, geophysicists [Glen Penfield](#) and Antonio Camargo were working for the Mexican state-owned oil company [Petróleos Mexicanos \(Pemex\)](#) as part of an airborne magnetic survey of the [Gulf of Mexico](#) north of the [Yucatán Peninsula](#).^{[17]:20–21} Penfield's job was to use geophysical data to scout possible locations for oil drilling.^[8] In the offshore magnetic data, Penfield noted anomalies whose depth he estimated and mapped. He then obtained onshore [gravity data](#) from the 1940s. When the gravity maps and [magnetic anomalies](#) were compared, Penfield described a shallow "bullseye", 180 km (110 mi) in diameter, appearing on the otherwise non-magnetic and uniform surroundings—clear evidence to him of an impact feature.^{[8][5]} A decade earlier, the same map had suggested a crater to contractor Robert Baltosser, but Pemex corporate policy prevented him from publicizing his conclusion.^{[17]:20}

Penfield presented his findings to Pemex, who rejected the crater theory, instead deferring to findings that ascribed the feature to volcanic activity.^[5] Pemex disallowed release of specific data, but let Penfield and Camargo present the results at the 1981 [Society of Exploration Geophysicists](#) conference.^[15] That year's conference was under-attended and their report attracted little attention, as many experts on impact craters and the K–Pg boundary were attending the Snowbird conference instead. Carlos Byars, a [Houston Chronicle](#) journalist who was familiar with Penfield and had seen the gravitational and magnetic data himself, wrote a front-page story^[18] on Penfield and Camargo's claim, but the news did not propagate widely.^{[17]:23}



Artist's impression of the asteroid slamming into tropical, shallow seas of the sulfur-rich [Yucatán Peninsula](#) in what is today [Southeast Mexico](#).^[16] The aftermath of the asteroid collision, which occurred approximately 66 million years ago, is believed to have caused the [mass extinction](#) of non-avian dinosaurs and many other species on Earth.^[16] The impact spewed hundreds of billions of tons of sulfur into the atmosphere, producing a worldwide blackout and freezing temperatures which persisted for at least a decade.^[16]

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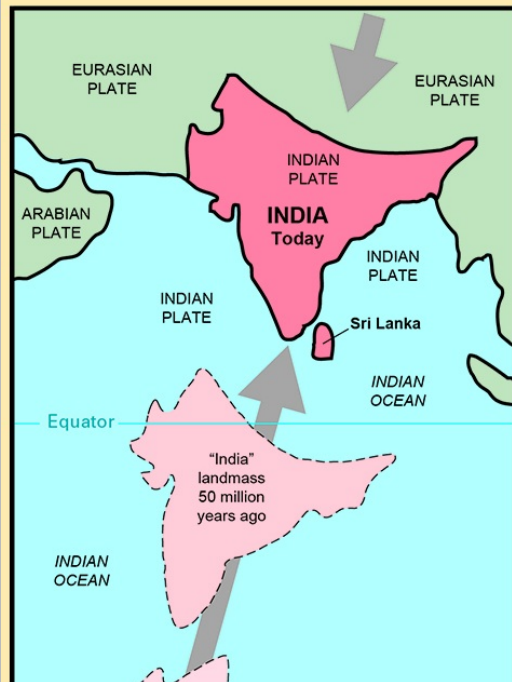
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[11] Chicxulub found by Camargo and Penfield, late 1970s (Wikipedia)

The Himalayas: Two continents collide

Among the most dramatic and visible creations of plate-tectonic forces are the lofty Himalayas, which stretch 2,900 km along the border between India and Tibet. This immense mountain range began to form between 40 and 50 million years ago, when two large landmasses, India and Eurasia, driven by plate movement, collided. Because both these continental landmasses have about the same rock density, one plate could not be subducted under the other. The pressure of the impinging plates could only be relieved by thrusting skyward, contorting the collision zone, and forming the jagged Himalayan peaks.

About 225 million years ago, India was a large island still situated off the Australian coast, and a vast ocean (called Tethys Sea) separated India from the Asian continent. When Pangaea broke apart about 200 million years ago, India began to forge northward. By studying the history -- and ultimately the closing-- of the Tethys, scientists have reconstructed India's northward journey. About 80 million years ago, India was located roughly 6,400 km south of the Asian continent, moving northward at a rate of about 9 m a century. When India rammed into Asia about 40 to 50 million years ago, its northward advance slowed by about half. The collision and associated decrease in the rate of plate movement are interpreted to mark the beginning of the rapid uplift of the Himalayas.



[12] The Himalayas began forming 40-50 million years ago (USGS)

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> Translations, versions and derivative works

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	(the Hermitage)		Dhritarashtra's bidding goes to live in the higher Himalayas.
16	Mausala Parva (The Book of the Clubs)	96	The materialization of Gandhari's curse, i.e., the infighting between the Yadavas with maces (<i>mausala</i>) and the eventual destruction of the Yadavas.
17	Mahaprasthanika Parva (The Book of the Great Journey)	97	The great journey of Yudhishthira, his brothers, and his wife Draupadi across the whole country and finally their ascent of the great Himalayas where each Pandava falls except for Yudhishthira.
18	Svargarohana Parva (The Book of the Ascent to Heaven)	98	Yudhishthira's final test and the return of the Pandavas to the spiritual world (<i>svarga</i>).
<i>khila</i>	Harivamsa Parva (The Book of the Genealogy of Hari)	99–100	This is an addendum to the 18 books, and covers those parts of the life of Krishna which is not covered in the 18 parvas of the <i>Mahābhārata</i> .

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Historical context

The historicity of the [Kurukshetra War](#) is unclear. **Many historians estimate the date of the Kurukshetra war to Iron Age India** of the 10th century BCE.^[45] The setting of the epic has a historical precedent in Iron Age ([Vedic](#)) India, where the [Kuru](#) kingdom was the center of political power during roughly 1200 to 800 BCE.^[46] A dynastic conflict of the period could have been the inspiration for the *Jaya*, the foundation on which the *Mahābhārata* corpus was built, with a climactic battle, eventually coming to be viewed as an epochal event.

[Puranic literature](#) presents genealogical lists associated with the *Mahābhārata* narrative. The evidence of the Puranas is of two kinds. Of the first kind, there is the direct statement that there were 1,015 (or 1,050) years between the birth of [Parikshit](#) (Arjuna's grandson) and the accession of [Mahapadma Nanda](#) (400–329 BCE), which would yield an estimate of about 1400 BCE for the Bharata battle.^[47] However, this would imply improbably long reigns on average for the kings listed in the genealogies.^[48] Of the second kind is analysis of parallel genealogies in the Puranas between the times of Adhisimakrishna ([Parikshit's](#) great-grandson) and [Mahapadma Nanda](#). Pargiter accordingly estimated 26 generations by averaging 10 different dynastic lists and, assuming 18 years for the average duration of a reign, arrived at an estimate of 850 BCE for Adhisimakrishna, and thus approximately 950 BCE for the Bharata battle.^[49]

[B. B. Lal](#) used the same approach with a more conservative assumption of the average reign to estimate a date of 836 BCE, and correlated this with archaeological evidence from [Painted](#)

[13] Historians: possible Kurukshetra war date around the 10th century BCE (Wikipedia: Mahabharata)

“When Lived: About 300,000 years ago to present”
Smithsonian National Museum of Natural History, Human Origins - Homo sapiens, <https://humanorigins.si.edu/evidence/human-fossils/species/homo-sapiens> - (c) Smithsonian Institution; one-line fact quoted with attribution for review.

[14] Homo sapiens: about 300,000 years ago to present (quoted text)

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cultural consciousness of many nations, both [Hindu](#) and [Buddhist](#). Its most significant moral influence was the importance of virtue, in the life of a citizen and in the aspirational ideals guiding the functioning of a state (from [Sanskrit](#): रामराज्य, *romanized*: *Rāmarājya*, a utopian state where Rama is king) or a society.

Etymology

[edit]

The name *Rāmāyana* is composed of two words, *Rāma* and *ayana* "travel, journey", with the grammatical [internal sandhi](#) "joining" of the final short *a* in *Rāma* and the initial short *a* in *ayana* to the longer form *ā*.^[14] *Rāma*, the name of the main figure of the epic, has two contextual meanings. In the [Atharvaveda](#), it means "dark-coloured or black" and is related to the word *rātri* "the darkness or stillness of night". The other meaning, which can be found in the *Mahabharata*, is "pleasing, pleasant, charming, lovely, beautiful".^{[15][16]} Thus, *Rāmāyana* means "[Rama's journey](#)".^[17]

Dating

[edit]

Scholarly estimates of the composition of the available text range from the 8th–5th^{[1][2]} to 5th-4th **centuries BCE** ^{[3][a]} "although the legends constituting it go back farther in time"^[2] and later stages extend to the 3rd century CE.^[3] [Robert P. Goldman](#) (1984) gives 750 BCE to 500 BCE as the probable date of the oral^[18] composition of Valmiki's Ramayana, stating that "it is extremely unlikely that the archetype of the Vālmiki Rāmāyaṇā can be much earlier than the beginning of the seventh century B.C.",^[1] while the core portions could not have been composed later than the 6th or 5th century BCE, as the narrative neither mentions Buddhism (founded in the 5th century BCE) nor reflects the later prominence of [Magadha](#) (which rose to power in the 7th century BCE). The text also mentions [Ayodhya](#) as the capital of [Kosala](#), rather than its later name of Saketa or its successor capital of [Shravasti](#).^[c]

[Goldman & Sutherland Goldman](#) (2022) consider Valmiki's Ramayana to be composed around mid-first millennium BCE.^[a]

Books two to six are the oldest portion of the epic, while the first and last books (*Balakanda* and *Uttara Kanda*, respectively) are considered to be later additions. Style differences and narrative contradictions between these two volumes and the rest of the epic have led scholars including Hermann Jacobi toward this consensus.^{[19][20]}

Textual characteristics

[edit]

Genre

[edit]



Rama's journey during exile (with wife, Sita and brother, Lakshmana), forms central narrative of Ramayana

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[15] Ramayana composition: about 8th-5th to 5th-4th centuries BCE (Wikipedia)

Last Glacial Maximum

🇺🇸 29 languages ▾

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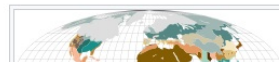
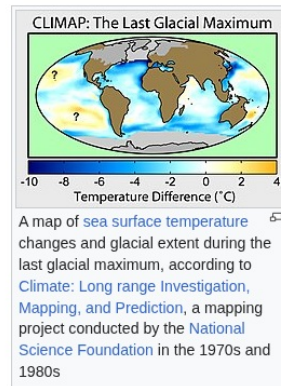
The **Last Glacial Maximum (LGM)**, also referred to as the **Last Glacial Coldest Period**,^[1] was the most recent time during the **Last Glacial Period** where **ice sheets** were at their greatest extent **between 26,000 and 20,000 years ago**^[2] Ice sheets covered much of Northern **North America**, **Northern Europe**, and **Asia** and profoundly affected **Earth's** climate by causing a major expansion of deserts,^[3] along with a large drop in sea levels.^[4]

Based on changes in position of ice sheet margins dated via [terrestrial cosmogenic nuclides](#) and [radiocarbon dating](#), growth of ice sheets in the southern hemisphere commenced around 33,000 years ago and maximum coverage has been estimated to have occurred sometime between 26,500 years ago^[1] and 20,000 years ago.^[5] After this, deglaciation caused an abrupt rise in sea level. Decline of the West [Antarctica](#) ice sheet occurred between 15,000 and 14,000 years ago, consistent with evidence for another abrupt rise in the [sea level](#) around 14,500 years ago.^{[6][7]} Glacier fluctuations around the [Strait of Magellan](#) suggest the peak in glacial surface area was constrained to between 25,200 and 23,100 years ago.^[8]

There are no agreed dates for the beginning and end of the LGM, and researchers select dates depending on their criteria and the data set consulted. Jennifer French, an archeologist specialising in the European Palaeolithic, dates its onset at 27,500 years ago, with ice sheets at their maximum by around 26,000 years ago and deglaciation commencing between 20,000 and 19,000 years ago.^[9] The LGM is referred to in Britain as the **Dimlington Stadial**, dated to between 31,000 and 16,000 years ago.^{[10][11]}

Glacial climate [\[edit \]](#)

The average global temperature around 21,000 years ago was about 6 °C (11 °F) colder than today.^{[12][13][14]} According to the



[16] Last Glacial Maximum: 26,000-20,000 years ago (Wikipedia)

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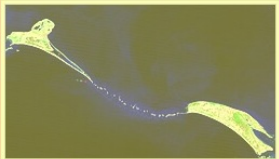
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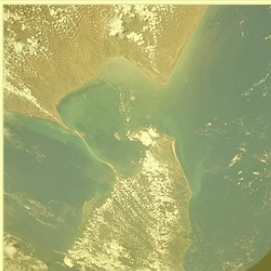
by the god [Rama](#) to reach the island [Lanka](#) and rescue his wife [Sita](#) from [Ravana](#). Many scholars locate the original Lanka in the eastern part of present-day [Madhya Pradesh](#).^{[4][5]} In popular Hindu belief, Lanka is equated to present-day Sri Lanka and the bridge is described as "Rama's Setu".^[6]

Geological evolution

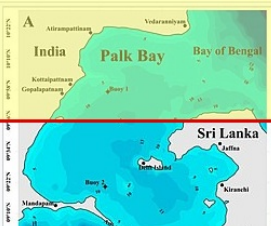


Landsat 5 image of Adam's Bridge

Due to lowered sea levels during the Last Glacial Period (115,000–11,700 years Before Present) where sea levels reached a maximum of 120 m (390 ft) below present values, the entirety of the relatively shallow [Palk Strait](#) (which reaches a maximum depth of only 35 m (115 ft)) was exposed as dry land connecting the mainland Indian subcontinent and Sri Lanka. Following the rise to present sea levels during the [Holocene](#), by around 7,000 years ago, the strait became submerged, including the region of Adam's Bridge/Rama Setu. The islands of Adam's Bridge became emergent again following sea level falls in the region from around 5,000 years ago to the present.^[5]



NASA satellite photo: India on top, Sri Lanka at the bottom



The bridge starts as a chain of [shoals](#) from the [Dhanushkodi](#) tip of India's [Pamban Island](#). It ends at Sri Lanka's [Mannar Island](#). Pamban Island is accessed from the Indian mainland by the 2 km (1.2 mi) long [Pamban Bridge](#). Mannar Island is connected

[20] The Palk Strait was dry land during the Last Glacial Period, submerged by about 7,000 years ago, shoals re-emerged from about 5,000 years ago (Wikipedia)

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arguments on vague speculation, false implications, and the point that – as with many geological formations – not every detail of its formation has been incontrovertibly settled.^[33] Indian Geologist [C. P. Rajendran](#) described the ensuing media controversy as an "abhorrent" example of the "post-truth era, where debates are largely focused on appeals to emotions rather than factual realities".^{[34][35]}

[NASA](#) said that its satellite photos had been egregiously misinterpreted to make this point during the protests against [Sethusamudram Shipping Canal Project](#). NASA noted: "The images reproduced on the websites may well be ours, but their interpretation is certainly not ours. [Remote sensing](#) images or photographs from orbit cannot provide direct information about the origin or age of a chain of islands, and certainly, cannot determine whether humans were involved in producing any of the patterns seen."^[36]

A report from the [Archaeological Survey of India](#) found no evidence for the structure being anything but a natural formation.^[37] The Archaeological Survey of India and the government of India informed the [Supreme Court of India](#) in a 2007 affidavit that there was no historical proof of the bridge being built by Rama.^[38] In 2017 the [Indian Council of Historical Research](#) (ICHR) announced a pilot study into the origins of the structure,^[39] but went on to shelve it.^[40]

In 2007, the Sri Lankan Tourism Development Authority sought to promote religious tourism from Hindu pilgrims in India by including the phenomenon as one of the points on its "Ramayana Trail", celebrating the legend of Prince Rama. Some Sri Lankan historians have condemned the undertaking as "a gross distortion of Sri Lankan history".^[41] The idea of Rama Setu as a sacred symbol to be appropriated for political purposes strengthened in the aftermath of protests against the [Sethusamudram Shipping Canal Project](#).^[42]

See also

- [Adam's Bridge Marine National Park](#)
- [Bimini Road](#), underwater rock formation in the



[20] ASI found no evidence the structure is anything but natural; NASA: satellite photos misinterpreted (Wikipedia)

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upon [Vishnu](#)'s request.

3. [Ravana](#) forced his elder brother [Kubera](#) to run away from Lanka after his penance to [Brahma](#) and [Shiva](#) and became the prince of Lanka; Sumali became the King of Lanka again. After [Sumali](#)'s death, he became the ruler of Lanka.

4. [Vibhishana](#), after [Ravana](#)'s death, and on the order of [Rama](#), ruled Lanka. He was given immortality by Rama, thus he has ruled Lanka and the Rakshasas ever since.

Location of Ravana's "Lanka" according to Ramayana

[edit]

The Lanka referred to in the still-extant Hindu Texts and the [Ramayana](#) (referred to as [Ravana's Lanka](#)), is considered to be a large island-country, situated in the Indian Ocean. Studies refer that the Palace of [Ravana](#) was located in [Sigrirya](#) the palace built by the [Kashyapa I](#) of [Anuradhapura](#) as the legend describes the capital of the kingdom was located between plateaus and forests. Some scholars asserted that it must have been [Sri Lanka](#) because it is so stated in the 5th century Sri Lankan text [Mahavamsa](#).^[5] The [Ramayana](#) states that [Ravana's Lanka](#) was situated 100 [Yojanas](#) away from mainland India.^{[6][7]}

Some scholars have interpreted the content of these texts to determine that Lanka was located at the point where the Prime-Meridian of India passes the [Equator](#).^{[8][9]} This island would therefore lie more than 160 km (100 mi) southwest of present-day country of Sri Lanka. The most original of all the existing versions of [Valmiki's Ramayana](#) also suggest the location of [Ravana's Lanka](#) to be in the western [Indian Ocean](#). It indicates that Lanka was in the midst of a series of large island-nations, submerged mountains, and sunken plateaus in the western part of the Indian Ocean.^{[10][11]}

There has been a lot of speculation by several scholars since the 19th century that [Ravana's Lanka](#) might have been in the Indian Ocean around where the [Maldives](#) once stood as a high mountain, before getting submerged in the Indian Ocean.^{[12][13][14][15]} This speculation is supported by the presence of

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[21] The Ramayana states Ravana's Lanka was situated 100 yojanas from mainland India (Wikipedia: Lanka)

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present-day Ayodhya. According to another theory, the legendary Ayodhya is a mythical city,^[37] and the name "Ayodhya" came to be used for the Saketa (present-day Ayodhya) only around the fourth century, when a [Gupta](#) emperor (probably [Skandagupta](#)) moved his capital to Saketa, and renamed it to Ayodhya after the legendary city.^{[28][38]} Alternative, but less likely, theories state that Saketa and Ayodhya were two adjoining cities, or that Ayodhya was a locality within the Saketa city.^[39]

As Saketa

Archaeological and literary evidence suggests that the site of present-day Ayodhya had developed into an urban settlement by the fifth or sixth-century BC.^[34] The site is identified as the location of the ancient Sāketa city, which probably emerged as a marketplace located at the junction of the two important roads, the [Shravasti-Pratishthana](#) north–south road, and the [Rajagriha-Varanasi-Shravasti-Taxila](#) east–west road.^[40] Ancient Buddhist texts, such as [Samyutta Nikaya](#), state that Saketa was located in the Kosala kingdom ruled by [Prasenajit](#) (or [Pasenadi](#); c. sixth–5th century BC), whose capital was located at [Shravasti](#).^[41] The later Buddhist commentary [Dhammapada-atthakatha](#) states that the Saketa town was established by merchant [Dhananjaya](#) (the father of [Visakha](#)), on the suggestion of king [Prasenajit](#).^[32] The [Digha Nikaya](#) describes it as one of the six large cities of India.^[32] The early Buddhist canonical texts mention [Shravasti](#) as the capital of Kosala, but the later texts, such as the Jain texts [Nayadhammakahao](#) and [Pannavana Suttam](#), and the Buddhist [Jatakas](#), mention Saketa as the capital of Kosala.^[42]

As a busy town frequented by travellers, it appears to have become important for preachers such as [Gautama Buddha](#) and [Mahavira](#).^[40] The [Samyutta Nikaya](#) and [Anguttara Nikaya](#) mention that Buddha resided at Saketa at times.^[32] The early Jain canonical texts (such as [Antagada-dasao](#), [Anuttarovavaiya-dasao](#), and [Vivagasuya](#)) state that Mahavira visited Saketa; [Nayadhammakahao](#) states that [Parshvanatha](#) also visited Saketa.^[36] The Jain texts, both canonical and post-canonical, describe Ayodhya as the location of various shrines, such as those of snake, the [yaksha](#) [Pasamiya](#), [Suvratasvamin](#), and [Surappia](#).^[36]

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[22] Ayodhya (ancient Saketa) had developed into an urban settlement by the 5th-6th century BC (Wikipedia)

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stone anchors with three holes. The settlements are in the form of exterior and interior walls, and fort bastions. From the [typological](#) classification of the anchors it is inferred that Dwarka had flourished as a port during the period of the [Middle kingdoms of India](#).^[17] [Coastal erosion](#) was probably the cause of the destruction of what was an ancient port. Another excavation near Dwarkadhish temple took place which have yielded a shrine dedicated to [Vishnu](#) from 9th century CE, furthermore excavation were conducted which yielded a settlement from 1st century BCE another excavation was conducted in the site for the antiquity of the town, have yielded a settlement probably contemporary to [Mahabharata](#) dated around 2nd millennium BCE.^[17]

Dwarka is mentioned in the copper inscription dated 574 CE of Simhaditya, the Maitraka dynasty minister of [Vallabhi](#). He was the son of Varahdas, the king of Dwarka. The nearby Bet Dwarka island is a religious pilgrimage site and an important archaeological site of the [Late Harappan](#) period, with one [thermoluminescence](#) date of 1570 BCE.^{[25][26]}

Early history

An epigraphic reference ascribed to Garulaka Simhaditya, the son of Varahdas, the king of Dwarka, is inscribed on a copper plate dated to 574 CE, found in [Palitana](#). The Greek writer of the *Periplus of the Erythraean Sea* referred to a place called Baraca, which has been interpreted as present-day Dwarka. A reference made in [Ptolemy's Geography](#) identified Barake as an island in the Gulf of Kanthils, which has also been inferred to mean Dwarka.^[17]

One of the [four dhams](#) (religious seats), which were founded by [Adi Shankaracharya](#) (686–717 CE) at the four corners of the country, was established as a monastic centre and it forms part of the Dwarka temple complex.^{[1][2]}

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[24] Bet Dwarka: Late Harappan site with a thermoluminescence date of 1570 BCE (Wikipedia)

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[Indo-Iranian](#) speaking people into the Indian subcontinent,^[12] "forming then the ruling elite of a major Late Harappan settlement."^[13]

Excavations

edit

The site at Sinauli was accidentally discovered by people levelling agricultural land. The farmers came across human skeletons and ancient pottery. The ASI began excavations at the site in September 2005.^[14]

2005–2006 excavations

edit

The 2005-2006 excavation headed by D. V. Sharma, ASI found more than a hundred burials (no coffins) tentatively dated c. 2200–1800 BCE.^{[6][4]} Sharma associated the finding with the [Indus Valley Civilisation](#),^[4] which has been contested, as a Late Harappan or post-Harappan identification is more likely.^{[6][4][15][4]} Carbon dating has now confirmed that the burials date back to c. 1865-1507 BCE, based on three samples: 3,500, 3,815, and 3,457 BP, with a margin of error of 295 years.^{[16][page needed]}

The burials are all oriented in a NW-SE direction and most are identified as primary burials. Some of the burials are identified as secondary, multiple and symbolic burials. The age of the buried starts from 1–2 years and includes all age groups and both male and female.^[6] [Grave goods](#) generally consisted of odd number of vases/bowls (3, 5, 7, 9, 11 etc.) placed near the head, with dish-on-stand usually placed below the hip area as well as flask-shaped vessels, [terracotta](#) figurines, gold bracelets and copper bangles, beads of semi-precious stones (two necklaces of long barrel shape), steatite, faience, and glass.^{[14][6]}

The two antennae swords from Sinauli, one found *in situ* in a grave with a copper sheath, has similarities to the [Copper Hoard](#) Type in a Late Harappan context.^[6] A dish-on-stand and a violin-shaped flat copper container (having nearly 35 arrowhead shaped copper pieces placed in a row) are included

Abandoned

c. 1500 BCE

Site notes

Excavation dates

2005-2006, 2018

Archaeologists

D. V. Sharma
Sanjay Manjul

Management

Archaeological Survey of India

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[25] Sinauli: carbon dating confirms the burials date back to about 1865-1507 BCE (Wikipedia)

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Tandya Brahmana and the Jaiminiya Brahmana, as well as the Mahabharata, mention that the Saraswati dried up in a desert.

Since the late 19th century CE, numerous scholars have proposed to identify the Saraswati with the Ghaggar-Hakra River system, which flows through modern-day northwestern-India and eastern-Pakistan, between the Yamuna and the Sutlej, and ends in the Thar desert. Yet, recent geophysical research shows that the supposed downstream Ghaggar-Hakra paleochannel is actually a paleochannel of the Sutlej,^[11] which flowed into the Nara river, a delta channel of the Indus River, which was abandoned. 10,000–8,000 years ago when the Sutlej diverted its course, leaving the Ghaggar-Hakra as a system of monsoon-fed rivers which did not reach the sea.^{[12][13][14]}

The Indus Valley Civilisation prospered when the monsoons that fed the rivers diminished around 5,000 years ago,^{[12][11][14][e]} and ISRO has observed that major Indus Valley Civilisation sites at Kalibangan (Rajasthan), Banawali and Rakhigarhi (Haryana), Dholavira and Lothal (Gujarat) lay along this course.^{[15][web 1]} When the monsoons that fed the rivers further diminished, the Hakra dried-up some 4,000 years ago, becoming an intermittent river, and the urban Harappan civilisation declined, becoming localized in smaller agricultural communities.^{[12][9][11][13][14]}

Identification of a mighty physical Rigvedic Saraswati with the Ghaggar-Hakra system is therefore problematic, since the Ghaggar-Hakra had dried up well before the time of the composition of the Rigveda,^[16] reduced to a "small, sorry trickle in the desert."^{[17][9][11][13][14][g]} Also, Rigvedic descriptions of the Saraswati do not match the actual course of the Ghaggar-Hakra.^{[21][22]} Furthermore, it is unlikely that the most important of Rigvedic rivers would lose its Sanskrit name and be renamed in a local dialect, whereas other rivers in the area preserved their names for thousands of years.^[23]

"Saraswati" may originally have been an adjective meaning "being full of water" and preserved when the Vedic people moved further eastwards.^[24] "Saraswati" has also been identified with the Helmand in ancient Arachosia, or Haraufatiš, in present day southern Afghanistan,^[25] the name of which may have been reused when the Vedic tribes moved to the Punjab.^{[25][21][h]} The Saraswati of the R̥gveda may

Appearance

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Text

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Automatic

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[26] 'The Hakra dried-up some 4,000 years ago' - Harappan decline followed (Wikipedia: Saraswati River)

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mountain is called *Gang Rinpoche* (Tibetan: གངས་རྒྱལ་པོ་ཤེ; *simplified Chinese*: 冈仁波齐峰; *traditional Chinese*: 岡仁波齊峰) or *Gang Tise* locally.^{[7][8][9]} *Gang Rinpoche* means "snow jewel mountain" with *Kang* (or *Gang*) being the Tibetan word meaning *white mountain* (snow peak) and *rinpoche* is an honorific meaning "precious one".^{[8][10]} *Gang Tise* means "mountain of ice or cool".^{[8][11]}

"Tibetan Buddhists call it Kangri Rinpoche; 'Precious Snow Mountain'. Bon texts have many names: Water's Flower, Mountain of Sea Water, Nine Stacked Swastikas Mountain. For Hindus, it is the home of the Hindu god Shiva...for Jains it is where their first leader was enlightened; for Buddhists, the navel of the universe; and for adherents of Bon, the abode of the sky goddess Sipaimen."

—*Alice Albinia* lists some of the names for the mountain, and its religious significance to various faiths^[12]

Geography and topography

Mount Kailash is located in Ngari Prefecture, Tibet Autonomous Region of China.^{[8][11]} It lies in the Gangdise Shan (also called as Kailash Range) of the Transhimalaya, in the western part of the Tibetan Plateau. The peak of Mount Kailash is at an

Parga

Wikimedia ☰ | © OpenStreetMap ☷

Location

Burang County, Tibet Autonomous Region

Country

China

Parent range

Gangdise Shan

Climbing

First ascent

None (prohibited)

Appearance

hide

Text

Small

Standard

Large

Width

Standard

Wide

Color

Automatic

Light

Dark

[27] Mount Kailash: 'For Hindus, it is the home of the Hindu god Shiva' (Wikipedia)



[28] NASA satellite photo of Adam's Bridge / Rama Setu: India above, Sri Lanka below, the shoal chain between them. Public domain (NASA), via Wikimedia Commons.

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